

Concept Note

SOUTHEAST ZONAL IT ASSEMBLY & WORKSHOP

Theme: Technology-Enhanced Development in the Era of Artificial Intelligence: The Pros and the Cons

The **SouthEast Zonal IT Assembly** is conceived as a high-impact regional technology, research, innovation and economic-development platform designed to position the SouthEast of Nigeria as a **formidable contributor to the global digital economy**.

Organised by the Nigeria Computer Society (NCS), SouthEast Zone, the Assembly will bring together government, academia, industry, researchers, technology professionals, innovators, entrepreneurs, investors and young people to explore how technology and Artificial Intelligence can accelerate sustainable development across the region.

Unlike a conventional conference, the Assembly will be driven by practical outcomes, bold ideas and lasting impact, built around four major pillars:

1. **Research Consortium** – connecting researchers, universities, industry and government to undertake collaborative research on strategic regional challenges. Through partnership with **IEEE**, the Assembly will seek to provide selected research with appropriate international visibility and recognition, subject to relevant publication and review requirements.
2. **Innovation Hackathon** – challenging young innovators, developers, researchers and entrepreneurs to create practical technology solutions to problems affecting individuals, businesses, communities and government.
3. **Technology & Economic Development Dialogue** – high-level conversations examining how technology can strengthen productivity, entrepreneurship, organizations, public services and government, while unlocking opportunities for investment and economic growth.
4. **Leadership & Innovation Recognition** – celebrating outstanding government officials, industry leaders, researchers, entrepreneurs and innovators of Igbo origin whose contributions have advanced technology, governance, enterprise and economic development.

A major objective is to establish the Assembly as a lasting regional institution rather than a one-off event. Each edition will pursue tangible outcomes including research publications, policy recommendations, innovation prototypes, strategic partnerships, investment opportunities and a documented record of outstanding technology and development leaders.

The organisers therefore seek the strategic partnership and sponsorship of a Governor of one of the SouthEast States as Principal Sponsor/Host. Government involvement will provide institutional support, strengthen government–industry–academia collaboration and

demonstrate the State's commitment to technology and innovation, while preserving the professional and intellectual independence of the Assembly.

The Assembly will have a strong international outlook, engaging global researchers, technology organisations, development partners and the SouthEast diaspora.

Ultimately, the SouthEast Zonal IT Assembly seeks to create a platform where:

Research becomes Innovation → Innovation becomes Enterprise → Enterprise creates Economic Value → Technology drives Development.

The long-term vision is to build an Assembly whose research, innovations, partnerships, policies and recognised leaders become part of the documented history of technological and economic transformation in the SouthEast.

The Assembly Environment

The event venue will be transformed into an immersive technology environment, inspired by the digital experience of global technology events such as GITEX Dubai. From the moment participants enter, they will feel the presence of technology, innovation and possibility, while the main hall will present a magnificent, world-class ambience worthy of a landmark regional technology gathering.

Publicity

The Assembly will be promoted across major media and digital platforms, ensuring that relevant stakeholders across Nigeria and beyond are aware and engaged. Publicity will be executed with the energy, scale and professional expertise associated with leading international technology events, generating excitement before, during and after the Assembly.

Speakers

Speakers will be drawn from distinguished individuals whose achievements speak for them—leaders who have made significant contributions in technology, industry, academia, entrepreneurship, governance or economic development relevant to the objectives of the Assembly. Priority will be given to exceptional talents and accomplished leaders of southeast origin, bringing together voices capable of inspiring, challenging and shaping the future of the region.

Tentative Programme of Events:

Day 1 (13th November, 2026):

Arrival and Registration and Networking and Resting

Day 2 (14th November, 2026):

Arrival and Registration 8am to 10am

Official Opening Ceremony: 10am to 12pm By Dr. Silas Ori, The MC.

- Introduction of Dignitaries and National Anthem, NCS Anthem
- **LOC Chairman Address** by Anambra State Chapter Chairman
- **State Welcome Address** by SSA to Governor Anambra State on Innovations.
- **Welcome Address** *Ugwuegbulam Chidiebere, NCS Zonal Coordinator, SouthEast Zone*
- **Opening Address:** *AI as catalyst for regional economic development by Chief Leo Stan*
- **Good will Message**
Dr. Charles Onyeukwu, Deputy President Nigeria Computer Society.
Dr. Donatus Njoku, IEEE Conference Coordinator, SouthEast Nigeria Section.
- **Keynote Address 1:**
Technology Enhanced Development in the Era of AI: The Pros and the Cons By Prof. Nebo
- Host Governors Address and Official opening of the event
- **Closing remark:**
Prof. Virginia Ejiofor, Lead, Programmes Committee, SouthEast Zonal IT Assembly, 2026
- **Group Photograph**
Dr. Ogbaga Member, SouthEast Zonal Working Committee
Photograph order: Government Officials with the ZWC
ZWC with the Governor
VIP Guests with the Governor
General Picture with the Governor

TEA BREAK

Panel Discussion 1:

Digital Governance and e-government role in Public Service (45mins)

- Commissioner for Digital Economy and e-government, Imo State
- Commissioner for Enterprise Development, Enugu State
- SA to Governor on Innovation and Economic Development, Anambra State
- SSA to the governor on Science and Technology, Abia State
- DG Ebonyi IT Development Agency, Ebonyi State

Symposium 1:

Preparing the Zonal workforce for the Ai-Economy (45 mins)

- **SouthEast Development Roadmap: Partnership Opportunities for Businesses and Researchers** (10Mins)
Hon. Mark Okoye, *The Chief Executive Officer: SouthEast development Commission (SEDC)*
- **Government interventions and enterprise-support opportunities for SouthEast Businesses and Startups.** (10 Mins)
Mr. Charles Odii, *Director General: Small and Medium Enterprise Development Agency of Nigeria (SMEDAN)*
- **Federal Policies, regulations and infrastructures that favor Tech Businesses and Startups in the SouthEast** (10 mins)
Dr. A. Onumo, *Director: Stakeholders Management and Partnerships, National IT Development Agency (NITDA)*
- **Tax Payment: what Southeast Businesses and Startups need to know.** (10mins)
Chief Keneth Egbufo, *Divisional head, Revenue Assurance, National Revenue Services.*

Guest Speaker 1:

Transforming Education and Research with Artificial Intelligence (15 mins)

Prof Bond Anyaehie – Vice Chancellor, Nnamdi Azikwe University Awka (UniZik)

LAUNCH

Fire Chat1:

Igba Boi in the AI Era: Leveraging Technology to Transform Apprenticeship and Drive Entrepreneurship (45 mins):

- **Ai-Powered Startups: Formation, ecosystem sustainability skills, and Opportunities**
CITP Andrew Agbo: *Founder Young Innovators of Nigeria (YIN)*
- **Extending Igba Boi into IoT: New Skills for Innovation, Projects and Enterprise**
Dr. Agu Collins Agu, *Founder & Chief Digital Architect, TD4PAI IoT Hub, Abuja.*
- **Extending Igba Boi into Software Development: Lucrative Skills for Innovation & Digital Economy**
Dr. Pius Okigbo Junior, *MD Nigeria Local Content Management Agency*
- **Student entrepreneurship: a catching them young strategy.**
Dr. Ijeoma Emeagi, *Director, Entrepreneurship Directorate, federal Polytechnic Nneke*

Cyber Security in the Era of Ai (15 Mins)

Dr. Ifeyinwa Okoye, Immediate past Chairman, Anambra State

FireChat 2

Professional practice: a catalyst for Southeast Regional Development (30 Mins)

- ***New IT Cadre circular of the Head of Civil Service***
Dr. Charles Onyeukwu, Deputy President, Nigeria Computer Society
- ***Participation and Benefits of Membership of NCS and CPN***
Engr Chidi Ugwuegbulam NCS Southeast Zonal Coordinator
Mrs. Nneka Agu, Chairman Publicity Committee, SouthEast.
- ***Chapter Membership Strength: Building new members, Activating old ones:***
Dr. S. A Ola, chairman Imo State Chapter
Engr David Okeya, chairman Anambra State chapter
Dr. Henry Ogbu, chairman Ebonyi State chapter
Hon. Hope Uwaga, chairman Abia State chapter
Prof B.C Iloka, chairman Enugu State

Closing Remark (10 mins)

Mrs Nneka Agu, Chairman, Publicity and Sponsorship Committee SouthEast Zone.

South East Zonal Anthem and closing Prayer (15 mins)

-Dr. Blessing Iduh, HOD Information Technology, Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka, (UniZik)

- **High Impact exclusive Meeting at 8pm**
HODs, Chapter Chairmen and Zonal Coordinator

Day 3 (15th November, 2026)

Introductions by the MC, (9AM).

Opening Prayer (10mins)

Dr. Adaora, Member, SouthEast Zonal Working Committee

Zonal Anthem (10 mins)

Mr. Nathaniel Nwamuo, Member Southeast Zonal Working Committee

Keynote Address 2: (20 Mins)

Ai powered Igbo Apprenticeship (igba boi) and Entrepreneurship

Barr. Osita Oparaugo

Symposium 3:

Research: a serious business and catalyst to zonal development (35 mins)

- **Research Grant: The best Practices**
Dr. Donatus Njoku, IEEE Conference Coordinator, SouthEast Nigeria Section.
- **Research to Startup in the new Era of AI.**
Engr. Chid Ugwuegbulam, CEO CodeSpace Technology LTD, Abuja
- **Scopus Made Easier: The Practical Path to a Publishable, Scopus-Ready Paper**
Prof A. Ifeanyi, Dean of SICT, Ebonyi State University

Guest Speaker:

Deep fakes and Phishing: Ai attacks, Ai defence. (15mins)

Mr. Alex Otuonye, MD Cyberetics Nigeria.

General Pictures (10 mins)

Dr. Sunny Onu, Member, SouthEast Zonal Working Committee

TEA BREAK (11 AM)

Three Parallel Sections on Paper Presentation (2 hrs)

LAUNCH BREAK (1 AM)

Research Consortium (30min)

Prof. Vincent Aso, chairman, Paper Review Committee, Southeast Zonal Assembly, 2026.

Gift Adene, Member, SouthEast Zonal working Committee

South East Zone AGM (2hrs)

Ugwuegbulam Chidiebere, SouthEast Zonal Coordinator

Closing Remark (5mins)

Dr. Ogbaga Ifeanyi, Member, Southeast zonal working Committee.

Dinner and Award Night: 7:30 PM

Zonal IT game (20mins)

Nathanial Nwamuo, National Identity Management Commission, Abia State.

Hackathon/STEM Presentation (20mins)

Hon. Elvis Obi-Nwankwo, Head of Innovations Committee, South East Zonal IT Assembly, 2026.

Awards (1hr)

Dr. Adaora, Senior Lecturer, Computer Science Department, University of Nigeria Nsukka.

Closing Remark (10 mins)

Prof. Virginia Ejiofor, Dean of SICT, Nnamdi Azikiwe University Awka.

Closing Prayer (5mins)

Dr. Chinedu Secretary, Southeast Programmes Committee.

Closure 9:30pm.